Please Tell Me Who I Am

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/60236521.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Netossa/Spinnerella (She-Ra), Catra & Netossa & Spinnerella (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Netossa (She-Ra), Spinnerella (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Post-War, Fluff, Hair Brushing, Catra taking good care of her hair, Adora helping her out, Spinnetossa best moms

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2024-11-01 Words: 2,020 Chapters: 1/1

Please Tell Me Who I Am

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/60236521.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Netossa/Spinnerella (She-Ra), Catra & Netossa & Spinnerella (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Netossa (She-Ra), Spinnerella (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Post-War, Fluff, Hair Brushing, Catra taking good care of her hair, Adora helping her out, Spinnetossa best moms

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2024-11-01 Words: 2,020 Chapters: 1/1

Please Tell Me Who I Am

by Kurt_Angles_Tailbone

Summary

"Have you ever had curls?" Netossa asked, drawing her from her thoughts.

"Curls? No."

Spinnerella stepped around Catra, tilting her head. "I think I see what you mean, darling."

"See *what*?"

Netossa released her hair, stepping back. "Listen, kid, we've talked about this before, but I'm willing to bet you didn't exactly have a ton of these products growing up in the Fright Zone."

Catra has to learn how to navigate life after the war, and that includes taking care of her hair. Spinnerella and Netossa give her a helping hand.

Notes

Thank you to Eviebebeevie for betareading

See the end of the work for more notes

“Don’t you guys have something different than this?”

The clerk regarded her coldly. “This is a hairbrush, miss. We have many like it.”

Catra rolled her eyes in exasperation. Setting foot outside of Bright Moon Castle for the first time in a week, she hadn’t assumed the worst but something close enough to it. Upon entering the ‘emporium’ Glimmer gave her directions to, she had quickly realised those fears were founded. The clerk had recognised her as the commander of the Horde and treated her to terse courtesies and answers through clenched teeth and narrowed eyes.

It hadn’t gone well afterwards. Any entreaties for the hair products and special brushes Glimmer had talked about proved to be a dead-end—if she didn’t know better, she’d think it was the clerk’s first day on the job, shrugging and shaking his head at any suggestion or question she fielded.

“Yes,” Catra growled, “but this one,” she gestured at the brush on the counter again, a plain wooden thing with bushy bristles, “feels like it’s just pulling my hair out.”

The clerk’s eyes flicked to her messy ponytail. “I’m afraid no brush could salvage that. Might I advise cutting it off?”

No. The word welled up inside Catra like a visceral reaction, ready to fight off Prime’s hands before they could clamp around her head like a vice. The clerk must have noticed how her shoulders squared, how she instinctively sank through her knees, bared her teeth—

“Alright, that’s it.”

A hand on her shoulder. Netossa appeared in her periphery, and she was angry. Catra cringed from the jolt of dread rippling through her, and braced for the inevitable admonishment.

"I heard the whole thing," Netossa said, but she was looking at the clerk, rather than Catra. "You know it's your *job* to help her, even if she is from the Horde?"

"It cannot be helped that the miss does not know what she wants."

"*Bullshit*," Netossa hissed. "She's been very upfront about what she's after, and I know for a *fact* you guys have products catered to Magicats here."

Catra blinked rapidly. Behind them, she saw Spinnerella was there too, who offered her a friendly smile. Netossa squeezed her shoulder reassuringly. Slowly, her breath evened back out, silently repeating back Adora's mantras to herself. *I'm safe. I'm safe. Everything's alright.*

The clerk gave a long-suffering sigh. "Very well. If the miss would follow me—"

"No, we'll help her. You've done enough." Netossa made to turn away, guiding Catra with her, only to spin right back around. "Oh, and you can bet I'll be lodging a complaint about this."

The clerk didn't seem quite so apathetic anymore. Catra followed Netossa into one of the shop's aisles, with Spinnerella flanking her on the other side.

"That guy was a dick," Netossa muttered, releasing Catra's shoulder.

"Language, darling." Spinnerella looked at Catra. "Are you alright?"

Catra tossed her chin, shrugging. "Sure. I've dealt with worse."

"Well, I don't doubt it, but he was still out of line."

"What, for refusing to help me?" Catra shrugged again, even if it was a little more forced. "Seriously, I'm not bothered about it.

Can’t really blame him, considering, y’know, I fought a *war* against you guys. Against him.”

“Maybe,” Spinnerella amended. “But you saved the world too.”

Catra sighed, walking further into the aisle. “Can we… not? Today? I hear enough of that at the meetings.”

“No problem, kid,” Netossa said easily. “So, you need help with your hair?”

“Yeah.” Catra brushed a claw through her ponytail. “Castaspella gave me a haircut, but… it’s still tangled, and Adora’s brush doesn’t feel great.”

Spinnerella pulled a brush from the shelf, a flat, compact one with thick, spacious bristles. It was reminiscent of the kind Shadow Weaver used to tear at her hair with. “Like this?”

Catra’s jaw tightened. “Yeah, sorta.”

Spinnerella must have noticed her reaction, lips forming a thin, sympathetic line. “I see. Don’t worry, they’ve got much better stuff here.”

“I’ll find you some hair products,” Netossa said, moving into a different aisle. “You go get your ideal brush.”

Catra joined Spinnerella in browsing the shelves. “What about this?” she asked, pulling out a long, flat brush that only had one line of narrow, metallic teeth.

“I don’t think such a comb would suit you, dear,” Spinnerella said after glancing over. “Not now, anyway.”

A comb. Catra committed the name to memory and put it back with the others.

She found she wasn’t at all self-conscious about asking the names of things when it concerned Spinnerella and Netossa. At most,

they might frown or raise their brows in quiet surprise before answering, but Catra would take that over the often-irritating shock and outrage Bow and Glimmer displayed whenever another shortcoming of Catra's upbringing was brought to light.

To that end, she felt confident enough to pick a different, more familiar brush. Catra had seen its kind before as one of Shadow Weaver's left-behind possessions, after the witch was thrown into a cell and Catra took her quarters over. "And this?"

"Ah, that's a straightener, if that's something you're after."

Catra hummed, deciding to keep it. She padded over to Spinnerella, who was standing by a small section separate from the rest of the shelves, marked by a pair of ears not unlike hers.

"This is what Netossa was talking about," Spinnerella said. "Everything you see here is tailored towards Magicats."

Catra squinted, feeling at the bristles of one of the brushes. "These… don't seem comfortable."

"Oh, I should clarify." Spinnerella picked up one of the square brushes, its teeth short and dense. "These are for your fur."

"I'm supposed to brush my fur?" Catra muttered.

"Only if you want to," Spinnerella said with a smile. "Here, these labels will list the benefits and what the specific brush specialises in."

Catra pinched the label between her fingers. *Reduces shedding. Prevents hair clumps. Reduces matting.*

"You've never used one of these before?" Spinnerella asked.

"No. Never."

"Then I suggest buying several, and seeing which ones you like best." Spinnerella smiled. "It'll save you a trip, at the least."

“But what about my hair? That’s what I came here for. The one Adora gave me…” She lowered her voice, even though Netossa was far away—for whatever reason, admitting to this in the presence of the other princess felt far too exposing. “…hurts, you know?”

“I understand,” Spinnerella said, devoid of judgement. “Let’s see here…”

She led them back to the rest of the brushes, where she diligently started picking through the stock.

“There you are. Oh, just take my basket. Here—” Spinnerella passed over her straw basket to Catra, filling it with one brush after the other. “We’ll start with this one,” she said, indicating a brush with long, flexible bristles. “It’ll get the knots out without too much stress on your scalp. After that, you can move over to one of these two.” She gestured to a shorter brush, its bristles fawning out like a porcupine, and a flower-shaped one, wide and round. “They’ll get your knots out in an instant, though I recommend washing your hair first.”

“And that’s where these babies come in!” Netossa rejoined them, arms filled with bottles, phials and flasks. “These will have you shining even more than your girlfriend in no time, kid.”

Catra stared at the bottles as Netossa dumped them in her basket. “Why so *many*?” She picked up a few of the phials. “I mean… ‘after-shower coconut oil’? ‘Tranquil Rose fur conditioner?’”

“You’ll have to give them a go first, sure, but I somehow doubt the price will be much of an issue for you,” Netossa said, nudging her. “Trust me, kid, this kind of stuff is totally worth it.”

Catra broke the seal on one, giving it a whiff. The scent of something strangely soft and impossibly sweet assailed her, thick enough that she quickly sealed it and stowed it back in the basket. “Uff. Okay. I’ll take your word for it.”

“What’s this you’ve found?” Netossa picked the straightener out of the basket, scrutinising it and then Catra’s ponytail critically. “Do you use these things?”

“No, but…” Catra didn’t know how to explain herself. Suddenly the one tether of familiarity that compelled her to use it felt flimsy and inconsequential.

“Hey, kid, can you let me take a look at your hair?”

Catra frowned. “Uh, sure?”

“Just take out your ponytail. Let’s see here…” Catra chewed on her upper lip while Netossa ran her fingers through the hair that now spilled into her vision. It wasn’t exactly ideal, but it was still easier to pretend she didn’t mind something than to actually voice that kind of *vulnerability*.

“Have you ever had curls?” Netossa asked, drawing her from her thoughts.

“Curls? No.”

Spinnerella stepped around Catra, tilting her head. “I think I see what you mean, darling.”

“See *what*?”

Netossa released her hair, stepping back. “Listen, kid, we’ve talked about this before, but I’m willing to bet you didn’t exactly have a ton of these products growing up in the Fright Zone.”

Catra tossed the filled-up basket a meaningful look. “You think?”

“Don’t sass me.” Netossa swiped one of the brushes from the shelves, replacing one of the ones Spinnerella had put in her basket. “Next time you take a shower, how about you just try brushing out the knots, and use some of this conditioner.” She pointed out one of the conditioners. “That should get you started.”

"Get me started with *what*?"

"I'm certain your hair curls naturally, Catra," Netossa explained. "You'll just have to work on it to bring them back. There's some damage here, but nothing permanent."

Curls? Catra consciously ran her claw through her hair. "And if I don't want curls?"

The princesses looked at each other.

"That's up to you, dear," Spinnerella said gently. "You can do whatever you want with your hair. But, I think you won't know until you try."

The room was cold when Catra stepped out of the bathroom, the last wisps of steam trailing around her ankles and vanishing, but luckily Adora was there for her, taking her by her shoulders.

"What, missed me?" Catra angled her head back, smiling into the kiss Adora ghosted across her lips.

"Come on, I wanna smell it!"

Catra snickered, letting Adora lean over her and bury her nose in her hair, inhaling deeply. "Adora, it's still wet."

"Mmm…" Adora sighed, unbothered.

Catra giggled, instinctively clamping a hand over her mouth before the realisation she shouldn't be afraid of getting 'caught' hit her. All that was left was a lovely giddiness, warm and tingly, her tail curling up into the air.

“Remind me to thank Netossa and Spinnerella later. You smell *wonderful*.” Adora’s hands trailed down Catra’s arms. “Oh wow. Is this…?”

“The shampoo for my fur, yeah.”

“It’s so soft!”

“Not done yet.” Catra held up a pair of brushes. “I’ve gotta brush it out while it’s still wet.”

Adora snatched them out of her hand. “I call dibs.”

Catra’s ears pricked forward attentively. “You mean you wanna…?”

But Adora was already crawling onto the bed, sitting down cross-legged and patting the empty space in front of her. “I’ll be gentle.”

Catra smirked—if only to hide the embarrassing buzz of excitement—adjusted her towel, and settled down in front of Adora at the edge of the bed. She flipped her hair back. “Go on then, Princess.”

Adora reverently took Catra’s hair in hands, running the brush down gently, carefully pulling at the tangles wherever they caught. The feel of the new brush was nice, like a pleasant massage on her scalp, but the feel of Adora’s breath on her shoulders or the way her fingers grazed against her ears was so much nicer.

Before long, Adora had stopped her combing altogether, her fingers shifting to gently give Catra scritches instead. Catra melted against her chest, eyes closed in bliss. A purr filled the room, loud and content.

“You know,” Catra murmured, “I was supposed to brush my hair while it was still wet.”

“Well, we can always take another shower.”

End Notes

Inspired by this tweet!
https://x.com/amethystjar/status/1850325479884022043

This one was originally meant to take place after chapter 90 of They'll Know My Name, but honestly works perfectly well as any post-canon oneshot.

Work title is from The Logical Song. This is the most Adora-core song I've ever heard in my life, so obviously I wrote a Catra-centric fic with it.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!